Incident Report: cowrie-honeypot

Report ID: IR-03
Date: 2026-10-28
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1. Executive Summary

On October 21, 2026, an SSH brute-force attack was detected against a Dockerized Cowrie Honeypot running on port 2222. The attacker (172.17.0.1) successfully logged in using credentials `root:admin` (which the honeypot accepts by design) and executed reconnaissance commands including `whoami`. Wazuh detected the activity via custom rules 100500 (successful login) and 100502 (command execution), both mapped to MITRE ATT&CK T1078 (Valid Accounts) and T1059 (Command Execution). No real system was compromised.

2. Attack Details

Field	Value
Attack Type	SSH Honeypot Login
Source IP	172.17.0.1
Target	Cowrie Honeypot (Docker)
Port	2222
Username	root
Password	admin
Commands	whoami, exit

3. Detection

Rule ID: 100500, 100501, 100502
Rule Level: 8, 8, 10
Rule File: `local_rules.xml`
MITRE ATT&CK: T1078 (Valid Accounts), T1110 (Brute Force), T1059 (Command Execution)

Rule Logic

“‘xml cowrie.login.success Cowrie: Successful Honeypot Login T1078